

Jingni Zhang

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[Personal Website](#)

EDUCATION

Syracuse University

Syracuse, NY

Ph.D. in Public Administration and International Affairs

Sep 2023-Present

- Fields of specialization: Environmental Policy; Public Finance; Policy Process
- Committee: Dr. David Popp (Advisor); Dr. Peter Wilcoxon; Dr. Yilin Hou
- Dissertation Topic: Three Essays on Governing Electric Vehicle Innovation: Policy, Knowledge Spillovers, and Road-Use Tax Design
- Research interest: energy policy, technological innovation, electric vehicle innovation, tax design for emerging technologies

Cornell University

Ithaca, NY

Master of Public Administration

Sep 2021-Jun 2023

- Concentration: Economic and Financial Policy

St. Lawrence University

Canton, NY

Bachelor of Science, Majors: Environmental Studies; Psychology

Sep 2017-Jun 2021

WORKING PAPERS

- Driving Innovation: The Policy Tools Powering Electric Vehicle Technological Inventions. (with David Popp; under review in Research Policy; preprint in NBER and CESifo)
- Electric Vehicle Road-Use Tax Design and the Fiscal Sustainability of Electrification.
- When Relationships Translate into Outcomes: Relational Governance in Third-Party Implementation. (with Yiying Chen)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Electric Vehicle and State Gasoline Tax Revenue in the United States. (with Pengju Zhang)
- Who Drives Electric Vehicle Knowledge? Government Support, Spillovers, and Innovation Networks.

AWARDS & FUNDING

2026	Summer Research Funding, Maxwell School at Syracuse University
2025	Best Poster Award at Association for Budgeting & Financial Management (ABFM) Annual Conference

2025	Travel Funding, Maxwell School at Syracuse University
2025	Inter-University Consortium Travel Grant
2025	Summer Research Funding, Maxwell School at Syracuse University
2023-Present	Graduate Research Stipend, Maxwell School at Syracuse University
2023	Pi Alpha Member, Jeb E. Brooks School at Cornell University
2014-2021	International Student Scholarship at St. Lawrence University

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026	“Who Drives Electric Vehicle Knowledge? Government Support, Spillovers, and Innovation Networks.” Association for Public Policy and Management (APPAM) Annual Conference, Boston, MA.
2026	“Electric Vehicle Road-Use Tax Design and the Fiscal Sustainability of Electrification.” Association for Budgeting & Financial Management (ABFM) Annual Conference, Washington, DC.
2026	“Electric Vehicle and State Gasoline Tax Revenue in the United States.” Association for Budgeting & Financial Management (ABFM) Annual Conference, Washington, DC.
2026	“When Relationships Translate into Outcomes: Relational Governance and Policy Achievement in Third-Party Implementation.” Public Management Research Conference (PMRC), Washington, DC.
2026	“Electric Vehicle and State Gasoline Tax Revenue in the United States.” Public Finance and Budgeting Northeastern Workshop, Hartford, CT.
2025	“Driving Innovation: The Policy Tools Powering Electric Vehicle Technological Inventions.” Association for Public Policy and Management (APPAM) Annual Conference, Seattle, WA.
2025	“Taxing EV Use by Time and Place.” Association for Budgeting & Financial Management (ABFM) Annual Conference, Atlanta, GA.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES (TEACHING ASSISTANT)

Maxwell School of Citizenship & Public Affairs, Syracuse University **Syracuse, NY**

Economics for Public Decisions, Fall 2026

Public Administration and Democracy, Summer 2026

- Independently facilitated and led daily discussion section for 25+ students, incorporating simulations and structured activities to foster inclusive participation and applied understanding of course content.

Economics for Policy Analysis (Undergraduate level), Spring 2026

- Guest lecture on “Price Floor” and “Price Ceiling.”

Guest lecture on “Command and Control Policies for the Environment” for Environmental Economics, Spring 2025

Economics for Public Decisions, Fall 2024

- Guest lecture on “Environmental Externalities.”

Fundamentals of Policy Analysis, Fall 2024

- Guest lecture on “Environmental Externalities.”

Public Administration and Democracy, Summer 2024

- Independently facilitated and led daily discussion section for 20+ students, incorporating simulations and structured activities to foster inclusive participation and applied understanding of course content.

International Management and Leadership, Fall 2023

- Guest lecture on “Organizational Budget.”

Jeb E. Brooks School of Public Policy, Cornell University

Ithaca, NY

Economics of the Public Sector, Spring 2023

(All courses at graduate level unless indicated; all guest lectures taught independently)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

Syracuse University

Syracuse, NY

Graduate Research Associate, Center for Policy Research

Sep 2023-Present

Graduate Research Associate, Center for Policy Design and Governance

Sep 2023-Present

Cornell University

Ithaca, NY

Research Assistant, Jeb E. Brooks School of Public Policy

Jun 2022-Feb 2023

Tsinghua University

Beijing, China

Research Assistant, School of Public Policy and Management Jun 2020-Jan 2021 & Jun 2019-Aug 2019

SERVICES

- Panel organizer for APPAM Fall Research Conference 2026

SKILLS

- Languages: Mandarin Chinese (Native); English (Fluent)
- Proficient in Stata, Python, SQL, RStudio, SPSS, and Microsoft Office